

The Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Model



What is Thomas Kilmann Model?

The Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Mode Instrument (TKI) is a widely recognised framework designed to measure an individual's response to conflict situations, Developed by psychologists Kenneth Thomas and Ralph Kilmann in the early 1970s, the model identifies five primary 'modes' of dealing with conflict, distinguished by two dimensions - Assertiveness and Cooperativeness.

Assertiveness



The extent to which an individual attempts to satisfy their own concerns

Cooperativeness

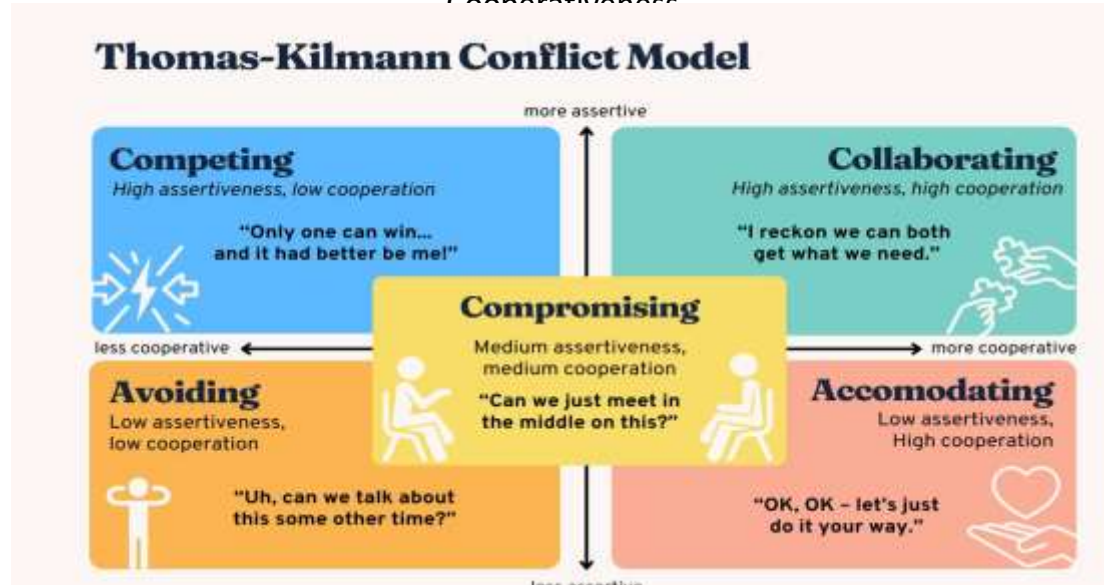


The extent to which an individual attempts to satisfy the concerns of the other person

How the TKI Model manages conflicts?

A conflict is a natural part of every workplace. It occurs when two or more individuals have different opinions, goals, values, or priorities. The Thomas-Kilmann Model explains that people manage conflict using five different styles based on two dimensions: Assertiveness and

Cooperativeness



The Conflict

Conflict Between Development Team and Testing Team

- ABC Technologies is developing a Banking Mobile Application for an important client. The Development Team has completed the coding and wants to release the application before the deadline.
- However, the Testing Team identifies several critical bugs that may affect customer transactions and overall system performance. The client expects the application to be delivered the next day.
- This difference in priorities creates a conflict between the Development Team and the Testing Team. This same scenario can be explained using all five conflict management styles.

Competing

A conflict management style where an individual focuses entirely on their own objective without considering others' concerns.

Key Dynamic: Characterized by high assertiveness and low cooperativeness

Best Applied: Suitable for urgent situations where quick, decisive action is absolutely required

Risk Factor: Frequent, unmoderated use can severely damage trust and relationships within the team



***“Only one can Win...,
and it had better be me!”***

Avoiding

A conflict management style where people choose to postpone or ignore the conflict instead of addressing it immediately

Key Dynamic: Characterized by low assertiveness and low cooperativeness

Best Applied: Suitable for minor issues

Risk Factor: It is generally ineffective for solving important problems



“Uh, Can we talk about this some other time?”

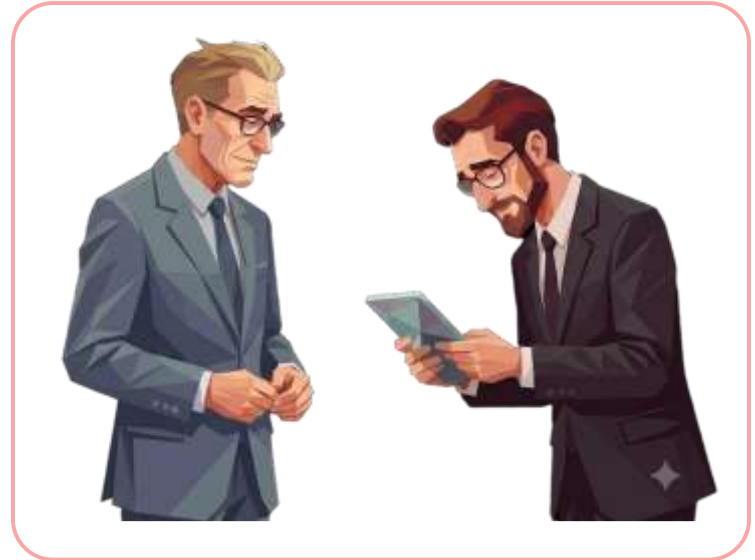
Accommodating

A conflict management style where one person gives up their own interests to satisfy the needs of others

Key Dynamic: Characterized by low assertiveness and high cooperativeness

Best Applied: Suitable for maintaining positive relationships

Risk Factor: One party may have to sacrifice their priorities



***“Ok, Ok let’s Just
do it your way.”***

Compromising

A conflict management style where both parties give up part of their demands to reach a mutually acceptable solution.

Key Dynamic: Balanced assertiveness and cooperativeness

Best Applied: Suitable when time and resources are limited

Risk Factor: May not address the root cause; both parties make concessions



“Can we just meet in the middle on this?”

Collaborating

A conflict management style which focuses on finding a solution that satisfies everyone and considered as most effective.

Key Dynamic: Characterized by high assertiveness and high cooperativeness

Best Applied: Suitable when a win-win solution is required

Risk Factor: Time consuming and resource intensive



***“I reckon we can
both get what we need.”***

Thank You.